

Tao Louie Xu, M.Sc.

The University of Edinburgh, Graduate School of Social and Political Science, 15a George Square, Edinburgh EH8 9LD
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Rerum cognoscere causas, a motivated individual graduating with the highest distinction from NUFE and a merit from the University of Edinburgh, preparing my doctoral application in the political economy of development to study the microfoundations of industrial policy and political settlements from an ideological change perspective. Proficient in NVivo, Stata, ArcMap, Python and open to both qualitative & quantitative methodologies, with extensive industrial and academic experience gained from Mazars, Deloitte, Duke Kunshan, NUFE, UoEdin, SUFE, and Fudan. Committed to continuous personal development, and seeking more professional challenges in international organisations and research universities to apply my knowledge and a transferable skill set.

SKILLS & RESEARCH INTERESTS

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|---|---|--|
| ▪ Institutional Political Economy of Development and Change | ▪ Heterodox Economics | ▪ Clientelism in Urban Industrialisation and Structural Transformation |
| ▪ Industrial Policy & Development | ▪ Microfoundations of Industrial Policy and Political Settlements | ▪ Critical Urban & International Development Studies |
| ▪ Political Settlements Framework | ▪ Institutional & Ideological Change | |

QUALIFICATIONS & AWARDS

M.Sc. Development Studies (International Development, Merit) - The University of Edinburgh, Nov 2024

Dissertation Topic: The Road Not Taken? Industrial Policy and Political Settlements in China and Indonesia 1990–2022

Supervisor: Hazel Gray, Ph.D., Senior Lecturer in African Studies & International Development

Key Modules: Anthropology of International Development · Political Economy of Development · Resource Politics and Development · Development Institutions & Practices · Poverty and Governance in Africa · Research Design

B.Sc. Economics (Commercial Economics, 1st: 91.29) - Nanjing University of Finance & Economics, Jun 2023

Dissertation Topic: Towards Sustainable Prosperity? Policy Evaluation of Jiangsu Advanced Manufacturing Clusters

Supervisor: Yabei Hu, Ph.D., Professor of Industrial Organisation

Key Modules: Microeconomics · Macroeconomics · Econometrics · International Economics · Regional Market and Interregional Trade · Regional & Urban Economics · Business Economics · Industrial Organisation · Economic History

Winter/Summer Schools, Workshops & Seminars

AI in Economic Theory & Methodology, Adv - University of Chinese Academy of Sciences, Jul 2024, 2025

Research Methodology in Applied Economics, Adv - Nanjing Agricultural University, Aug 2023, 2025

Advanced Modern Economics, Adv - Shanghai University of Finance and Economics, Jul 2025

Marxian Political Economy, Adv - Wuhan University, Jul 2023, 2024

Big Data Analytics in GISciences, Advanced - Nanjing Normal University, Aug 2023

International Business Management, Prof David French - UCLA & University of Saint Joseph, Jan 2022

Landlord State and Precarious Urban Agriculture in Accra, Prof Dzodzi Tsikata - Edinburgh CAS, Mar 2024

Political Economy of Extractivist Development in Ghana, Dr Gertrude Torvikey - Edinburgh CAS, Nov 2023

Skills, Courses & Certifications

Econometrics, Text Analytics & GISciences: Stata · NVivo · ArcMap · Python · VOSviewer · Matlab · CiteSpace

Communication & IT Literacy: (NCRE L2) Access · Excel · Publisher · Canva

Global Development Management, Seeing Institutions in Different Ways, Keynesian Economics - The Open University

Korean Economic Development - Yonsei University · Local Economic Development - Erasmus University Rotterdam
Understanding Research Methods - SOAS University of London · Game Theory - UBC and Stanford University
Microeconomics, Economics of Health Care Delivery, Comparative Health Systems - University of Pennsylvania
Health Systems Development, Epidemiology - University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill and Imperial College London
New Structural Economics, Advanced Quantitative Social Research, Science of Logic - Peking University and CUFE

Honours & Awards

Jiangsu Provincial Government Scholarship for Overseas Studies	NUFE Principal's Scholarship
Jiangsu Provincial Distinguished Dissertation Award 1st Class	NUFE Honours Graduate
NUFE Distinguished Dissertation Award	NUFE Honours Student
NUFE Merit Scholarship for Academic Excellence	NNU Outstanding Student Award
WHU Outstanding Student & Distinguished Paper Award	

Professional Memberships & Activities

Association for Social Economics · World Economics Association · Rethinking Economics

PUBLICATIONS

- "Towards Sustainable Prosperity? Policy Evaluation of Jiangsu Advanced Manufacturing Clusters," with Yabei Hu*, *Technology in Society*, 2024, 102583, honoured by Jiangsu Provincial Distinguished Dissertation Award

WORK IN PROGRESS

- "Endogenous Innovation in China: From Integrated Strategy to Geopolitical Narrative," with Li Liu*
- "Why Cities Backfire? High-Speed Railway New Town Planning and Urban Structural Change," with Yi Zhu
- "When Polanyi Met Schumpeter: Social Trust and Entrepreneurship," with Weiwei Zhu*, 2025, MPRA 123894, Under Review by *Economia e Politica Industriale*, *Journal of Industrial and Business Economics*
- "Reinterpreting the Political Settlements Framework with Structuration Theory," 2024, SocArXiv nmvhq
- "The Road Not Taken? Industrial Policy and Political Settlements in China and Indonesia 1990–2022," 2024, supervised by Dr Hazel Gray
- "It Takes Three to Ceilidh: Pension System and Multidimensional Poverty Mitigation in China," with Yansong Wang*, and Cheng Yuan, 2024, arXiv 2411.02807, (2025 Apr) Birmingham Business School-Nanjing Audit University Institute of Economics International Conference on Ageing, Inequality, and Sustainable Development
- "Peasant Life in Changing China: Rural Pension System Reform and Social Insurance Participation," with Zhengyi Hu, advised by Dr Yongliang Wu, 2022, arXiv 2204.00785

REPORTS, PRESENTATIONS & BOOK REVIEWS

- "Gu Yanwu's Neoclassical Confucianism and Entrepreneurship in Contemporary Kunshan, China," 2025
- "Economic Growth, Poverty Mitigation, and Social Policy in our Neoliberal Era: A Polanyian Perspective," 2024
- "Turbulence and Order in Economic Development: Economic Transformation in Tanzania and Vietnam by Hazel Gray," 2024, Edinburgh
- "Belt of Productivity, Road to Equality: People First Infrastructure Development in Indonesia," 2023, Edinburgh
- "Having People, Having Heart: Charity, Sustainable Development, and Problems of Dependence in Central Uganda by China Scherz," 2023, Edinburgh
- "Common Prosperity and the Middle Class," *WHU Proceedings of the Summer Institute on Marxian Economics*, 2023, 4, 1–5, Wuhan
- "The Theory of Economic Development by Joseph Schumpeter," 2022, Nanjing
- "A Study of History by Arnold Toynbee," 2021, Nanjing

- “Eudemonia and Freedom: Frontiers and Evolution of Employment Studies in China,” with Weiwei Zhu, advised by Prof Dr Wenwu Zhang, 2021, MPRA 112908, Nanjing
- “Survey on Local Pharmaceutical Specialty Stores: Retail Formats and Elements,” with Yukun Gu, Yibo Wang, Dapeng Zhu, Wei Li, Zhenyu Zhang, Jingxia Hou, and Yuhan Yang, advised by Prof Jinguo Tao, 2021, Nanjing
- “Mismatch and Dysfunction of the Ageing Economy: Digital Transformation in Silver-Hair Industry,” with Y. Gu, Y. Wang, and Q. Chen, *Journal of the Jiangsu Association for Commercial Economics*, 2021, 38, 1–9, Nanjing
- “Reshaping Silver-Hair Industry with New Retailing: A SWOT-Based Strategy,” *Journal of the China Federation of Logistics*, 2021, 28, 82–85, Nanjing
- “Survey on the Ageing Society in Rural Guannan: Consumption, Social Security, and Manufacturing for Silver-Hair Economy,” with Yukun Gu, and Yibo Wang, advised by Dr Qifei Chen, 2020, Guannan & Nanjing

RESEARCH & PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Fudan University (Shanghai) 2025 – Present

Co-Investigator - Fudan Development Institute and Shanghai Technology Commission 2025 – Present

- Worked on project-oriented research, e.g. ‘*Strategic Optimisation of Global Supply Chain Engagement with Development Zones in China’s Yangtze Economic Belt*’ advised by Dr Li Liu, on 4 projects assigned so far
- Independently drafted the Shanghai Key Think-Tank Project Proposal ‘*Tech Lead Firm Growth and Gradient-Heterogeneous Policy Toolkit in GVCs Governance*’ with Dr Liu for Shanghai Commission on Technology
- Reviewed cross-disciplinary literature spanning business life cycle, tech supply chain management, regional entrepreneurship, evolutionary innovation & industrial policy, authored 2 full reports (30,000+ words)
- Summarised a list of Shanghai-based pundits in supply chain management for project advisory committee
- Conducted a brief review of 20 papers on green agricultural transformation and sustainable rural livelihoods
- Engaged in Shanghai Forum 2025, reflected on talks by Keun Lee, Takehiko Nakao, Woo Wing Thye, and Michael Levitt on innovation strategy and global techno-nationalist policy change
- Drafted all the sections of a project-based work ‘Endogenous Innovation in the Tech Cold War Era’
- Interpreted the dynamic capabilities of endogenous innovation to sense techno-nationalism, seize the market-technology change, and reconfigure resources through technology exploration, market exploitation & ecosystem orchestration under positive externalities of institutional complementarity

Research Associate - Fudan Development Institute and Hefei University of Technology 2025 – 2026

- Worked on the 15th Shanghai Government Consultation Research Awarded Project ‘*Digital Social Innovation and Emerging Industries*’, with my subproject focus on new energy vehicle industry
- Articulated the structure of digital social innovation, its conceptual boundaries, actor subjects, objects, networked ecosystems, agendas, and gaps in social-commercial identity duality & techno-determinism
- Comparatively analysed the industrial change of automotive manufacturing in China, Japan, South Korea, Germany & US, and attributed China’s to policy experimentation & clustered innovation
- Mapped China’s NEV industrial policy trajectory since the 1990s, marked the shift from R&D incentives (tax credits & grants), public procurements, consumer subsidies towards market competition, full-chain industrial coordination & charging infrastructure provision, and drafted policy reports plus supplementary appendices
- Stylised facts and proposed recommendations on foresight social governance of industrial ecosystems, particularly regulatory gaps in flexible employment, social security, tax compliance, and labour rights

Shanghai University of Finance & Economics (Shanghai) 2024 – Present

Research Assistant - School of Public Economics & Administration 2024 – Present

- Reviewed the related work on high-speed railway and structural change, particularly on agglomeration economies, network-spillover effects of diffusion & the core-periphery framework, studied City Economics

by O'Flaherty and Handbook of Regional & Urban Economics by Duranton, Henderson, Thisse, and Cheshire

- Advised on 'Impact of High-Speed Railway New Town Construction on Land Prices' with Prof Dr Yi Zhu
- Employed the DiD approach, illustrated that HSR town planning in Yangtze Delta cities inhibits the average unit labour productivity of tertiarisation in hub cities but facilitates industrialisation in non-hub ones
- Examined the siphoning of the services in East China that labour & economic activities over-concentrate in core cities and industrial out-diffusion from hub cities enhancing secondary output of non-core areas
- Drafted 'Why Cities Backfire? High-Speed Railway New Town Planning and Urban Structural Change'

Peer Advisor & Teaching Assistant - College of Business

2024 – 2025

- Advised on a Master's dissertation 'Impact of Regional Trade Agreements on Export Resilience' supervised by Prof Dr Linke Zhu, mentored in research design and writing

Peer Advisor - Nanjing University Department of Finance (Nanjing)

2023 – 2025

- Mentored MPhil students in new structural economics, advised on economics causal inference & Bartik-IV
- Facilitated collaboration between students and PIs from Tsinghua PBC School of Finance & Peking Guanghua School of Management, supported studies on political trust in govt, SOE reform, and economic insecurity

Nanjing University of Finance & Economics (Nanjing)

2019 – 2024

Co-Investigator & Research Associate - School of International Economics & Business

2022 – 2024

- Worked on National Social Science Fund of China Programme '*Optimisation of Industrial Ecosystems for Advanced Manufacturing Clusters Based on Producer Services*' supervised by Prof Dr Yabei Hu
- Carried out a critical appraisal of the relevant literature on manufacturing and industrial policy, incorporating regional development economics and international business into a coherent theoretical perspective
- Selected, compiled, and perused the publicly available policy documents issued by corresponding functional departments of the Jiangsu government, qualitatively summarised the relevance of the gist
- Deployed a mixed methodology by a triple analytical framework, scrutinised policy themes, instruments & controls through textual mining and PMC index modelling with a dataset of 52 official documents
- Independently conducted data collection, visualisation, drafting & submission
- Produced original research paper 'Towards Sustainable Prosperity? Policy Evaluation of Jiangsu Advanced Manufacturing Clusters' published in *Technology in Society*, honoured by Provincial Distinguished Award

Co-Investigator & Coordinator - School of International Economics & Business

2021 – 2022

- Worked on National 'Culture, Science & Health to Rural China' Programme '*Cultural Heritage and Industrial Organisation in Less-Developed Areas*' with Weiwei Zhu, honoured by National Excellent Award, Provincial Special Award, and NUFE Best Report Award 1st Class
- Cooperated with the Shuyang government, conducted modern history investigation to organise specialised educational lecture series tailored to regional cultural endowments
- Introduced media campaigns across WeChat, Tiktok & Weibo for more visibility and accessibility of cultural heritage, integrate public participation into cultural preservation, tourism & economic development

Team Leader - Chinese Society for Optimisation & Economic Mathematics

2021

- Worked on 'MathorCup' Mathematical Contest in Modelling with Yansong Wang and Yukun Gu

Lead Investigator - School of International Economics & Business

2020 – 2021

- Initiated '*Reshaping Silver-Hair Industry with New Retailing: A Story of China*' with Dr Qifei Chen
- Led the project from inception to completion, not limited to fundraising, recruitment, duty allocation, and resource coordination to ensure timely delivery of research goals
- Managed online surveys targeting younger individuals, adopted an intergenerational perspective to analyse the influence of younger generations on the familiarity of older adults with smart devices & online shopping

- Reviewed the literature on ‘new retailing’ in the ‘silver-hair economy’, investigated market challenges in an ageing society, organised fieldwork in Guannan, interviewed older adults face-to-face to capture their very nuanced demands, consumption behaviour & digital technology adoption
- Identified the supply-demand mismatch in the silver-hair industry, proposed actionable strategy of big data in e-commerce logistics for rural & urban fringe areas, recommended by Tibet Chief Secretary Chunlai Zhou
- Published 2 reports ‘Reshaping Silver-Hair Industry with New Retailing’ & ‘Mismatch and Dysfunction of the Ageing Economy’, drafted 1 working paper ‘Rural Pension System Reform and Social Insurance Participation’ with feedback from a Bangkok-based World Bank economist

Student Assistant - NUFE Admissions Committee 2019 – 2021

Research Assistant - School of Business Administration 2020

- Worked on Jiangsu Administration for Market Regulation Programme ‘*Customer Satisfaction Evaluation of Tertiary Sector*’, ensured public participation of online surveys and collected data

Coordinator Assistant (Intern) - Duke Kunshan University Office of Student Affairs (Kunshan) 2023

- Facilitated liaison among students, faculty & leadership, handled administrative operations of event logistics, copyright license agreements, reimbursements, bilingual brochure & yearbook editions, and other duties
- Supported Campus Engagement student worker recruitment & training, interviewed for FYSAC Chairs (14), Orientation Leaders (107) & Commencement Volunteers (97), coordinated events, visualised survey data

Advisor Assistant (Intern) - Deloitte Division of Tax (Suzhou) 2021

- Co-drafted a 42-page report with my focus on fixed assets, intangible assets, tax credits, inventories & cross-border intra-group financing, translated 3 appendices, and selected 8/517 CUP comparables with TP Catalyst
- Advised on tax incentives & industrial layouts for foreign-invested manufacturers in Yangtze Delta and liaised with Xiamen SAFE Bureau & investment promotion agencies on intra-group capital reallocation accounting

Audit Assistant (Intern) - Mazars Division of Audit and Assurance (Suzhou) 2021

- Assisted with annual audits of Xiangcheng collective assets and Kunshan Hi-Tech Group, with my focus on P&L statement, balance sheet, large transaction, and state-owned asset confirmation
- Drafted 31 report sections and independently produced 7 audit working papers

Consultant Assistant (Intern) - CITIC Division of Wealth Management (Kunshan) 2020

Research Assistant - Administration for Market Regulation & Bureau of Finance (Kunshan) 2018 – 2020

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Language Proficiency

Fluent in English (IELTS Academic C1) and Mandarin with a good understanding of Wu and Literary Chinese

Peer Review

PLoS One · Heliyon · Journal of Infrastructure Policy and Development · World Development Sustainability · Journal of Chinese Governance

Referee List

Hazel Gray, Ph.D., SOAS University of London
Senior Lecturer,
The University of Edinburgh
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Yi Zhu, Ph.D., Massachusetts Institute of Technology
Associate Professor,
Shanghai University of Finance and Economics
zhu.yi@sufe.edu.cn